

The prime advantage of the concept of services is to automate system management, without the user having to launch applications or do something else. For example, in Windows 98, USB devices required installation of drivers. This was eliminated in XP due to the constant running of a service that automatically detects the presence of a USB device and installs a generic device driver for it.

### 8.3.1 Background Services

As mentioned earlier, services run in the background, where “background” refers to the fact that they’re hidden from the user. Windows XP comes bundled with an application that lets you view all running services.

Go to Start > Run, and type in “services.msc” and press [Enter]. This will bring up the Service Management Console. This console shows Windows XP services; apart from the name of the service, it also shows other useful



information such as Description, Status, Startup Type and Log On As.

Launching the Service management console

‘Description’ gives a brief idea of what the service does and what will happen when it is shut down.

‘Status’ indicates whether a service is running or not. If it is running, “Started” is displayed beside the name of the service.

‘Startup Type’ indicates the types of methods employed for starting the service. It can take three values: Automatic, Manual and Disable.

**Automatic:** This means the service was started by XP during the bootup process, and can be a critical service for the operation of the OS.